



Figure 1: Raw list of tasks being processed

have tags associated, based on the category. Each task can have (see Figure 2) priority, tags (for context), due dates, notes/ information required to perform the task (such as 'Next steps', which you should enter here). Tags can be used effectively to group tasks like calls, tasks assigned to a person, whether personal or work related, like @calls, @shopping, @billpay, etc.

- **SOMEDAY:** This list contains futuristic tasks/projects you would like to do, with no defined timeline—for example, learning a skill as a hobby or enrolling in a self-development course. Also, tasks that got suspended indefinitely due to waiting for an event or person can fall into this list.

Other cool features of MTT

- MTT's 'Due dates' feature lets you assign due dates to tasks that are time-bound or need to be performed on a particular day. MTT displays the due date of a future task, and the number of days that have lapsed for an overdue task.
- Hovering the mouse over a task tag hides all other tasks in the list that do not belong to that category. Lists can also be filtered based on the selection of tags.
- Where MTT is hosted on an Internet-accessible server, users can access tasks using the mobile browser—the layout is customised for small screens. (You can see a demo online at <http://mytinytodo.net/demo/?pda>.)
- Tasks can be assigned a priority; the tool gives a visual indication with a coloured number at the beginning of each task. Default (+0) priority has no prefix; top-priority tasks have '+2' shown in RED (see Figure 3).
- Users can search the complete set of tasks (including the Notes field of each task) using the Search field to the right of the New Task field. By default, search is done on tasks in the tab. To search all tasks, select the All Tasks tab.
- MTT reduces UI clicks with a feature called 'smart syntax', which allows users to enter a task in a particular format, including the task title, priority and tags: /priority/ task /tags/. Spaces after the / are required for the tool to distinguish tags.
- The Export feature enables tasks to be integrated with



Figure 2: Editing a task

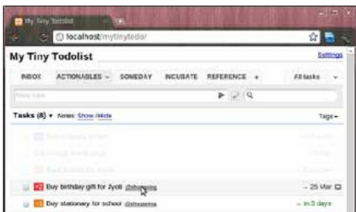


Figure 3: Priorities and tags

Microsoft Outlook Calendar when exported as *iCalendar*, and otherwise to be shared with others. By default, tasks are protected by a password. The user needs to explicitly choose *Publish* from the Tasklist menu, to make it available to other users.

MTT is an easy-to-use, flexible and powerful tool to implement the GTD workflow. Being available on LAMP allows users access anywhere. There is scope for enhancements and, hence, for you to contribute back to the open source community—for instance, by extending the tool to group of users (workgroup) and improving the smart syntax to add due dates in it. 

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This article in no way fully covers David Allen's *Getting Things Done* concept. For more on GTD, you could read the book '*Getting Things Done: The Art of Stress-Free Productivity*'.

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